

# The Ambiguous Brief

Skill focus: Working with Ambiguity · Decomposition

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Name \_\_\_\_\_

Class \_\_\_\_\_

Date \_\_\_\_\_

You've just been handed a real-world brief. It is *supposed* to feel incomplete — that's how real projects arrive. Your job today is **not** to start building. Your job is to figure out what you don't know, and to ask for it.

**The brief:** (*your teacher will give you this*)

**Step 1 — First instinct.** In two sentences: if you had to start *right now*, what would you do first? (Keep this. We'll come back to it.)

**Step 2 — Assumptions.** List every assumption you're making about this brief. ("I'm assuming the audience is...", "I'm assuming this should be a...")

**Step 3 — Questions.** List every question you'd need answered before you could confidently begin. Aim for at least eight. Then mark each one:

- **(M)** must know before I start
- **(L)** can figure out later

**Step 4 — The plan.** After the client answers your (M) questions, write your plan:

1. The phases, in order
2. The one step that must happen *first* (the blocker) — and why
3. A rough time estimate for each phase

**A good clarifying question** removes a real unknown ("Who is the audience?"). **A weak one** asks someone else to make your decision for you ("What color should it be?"). Aim for the first kind.

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